FREE GUIDE · @NOURISHBYTWO

ANCIENT CHINESE MEDICINE

# 5 TCM Ingredients That Change Everything

What we discovered in Shanghai — backed by 2,500 years of wisdom

Ginger · Jujube · Goji · Black Sesame · Turmeric

- What each ingredient does in TCM
- The science that confirms it
- How to use it starting today

Educational guide only. Not medical advice. Always consult a healthcare professional.

A NOTE FROM US

# Why these 5?

We moved to Shanghai as students with zero knowledge of Traditional Chinese Medicine. What we found changed how we eat, sleep, train, and feel — completely.

Chinese medicine isn't about exotic superfoods or complicated rituals. At its core, it's about understanding how food interacts with your body's energy systems — and making small, consistent choices that compound over time.

These 5 ingredients are our starting point. They're available everywhere, backed by both ancient wisdom and modern science, and easy to integrate into any lifestyle.

We use all 5 every week in our Shanghai kitchen. This guide is everything we wish we'd known from day one.

## What you'll discover in this guide

- The ancient name, energy profile & organ target of each ingredient
- The specific health benefit it's been used for — for 2,500+ years
- Modern scientific validation (where it exists)
- Simple ways to use it starting today — no special equipment needed
- A bonus recipe using all 5 together

**IMPORTANT**
This guide is for educational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. The information is based on Traditional Chinese Medicine principles and general wellness research. Please consult a qualified healthcare practitioner before making significant changes to your diet or lifestyle.

Sh■ng Ji■ng

01 / 05

# ■■ Fresh Ginger

Nature: Warm · Pungent · Organ: Stomach · Lung · Spleen

## ■ IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE

**Warms the digestive fire, disperses cold, stops nausea, promotes Qi circulation.**

In TCM, ginger is one of the most versatile medicinal foods. Fresh ginger (Sheng Jiang) is used to warm the middle burner, expel wind-cold, and harmonize the stomach. It's considered essential for supporting the digestive fire (Zhong Jiao) — the system responsible for transforming food into usable energy.

## ■ WHAT MODERN SCIENCE SAYS

Ginger contains gingerols and shogaols — compounds with proven anti-inflammatory and anti-nausea properties. Multiple clinical studies confirm its effectiveness for digestive discomfort, nausea, and reducing inflammatory markers.

## ■ HOW TO USE IT

- **Add 3-4 fresh slices to hot water every morning — before coffee**
- **Grate into soups, stir-fries, and broths**
- **Combine with jujube and goji for the classic TCM warming tea**
- **Use dried ginger (Gan Jiang) for stronger warming effect in winter**

■ **Avoid in large amounts if you tend to run hot, have acid reflux, or are pregnant.**

Sources: calebasse.com · institut-endobiogenie.fr · PubMed: Ginger anti-inflammatory studies

Hóng Z■o

02 / 05

# ■■ Red Jujube Dates

Nature: Warm · Sweet · Organ: Spleen · Stomach · Heart

## ■ IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE

**Tonifies Qi and blood, calms the mind, harmonizes other herbs.**

Jujube is one of the most revered tonics in the entire Chinese pharmacopoeia, mentioned in texts dating back 2,000 years. It's classified as a Qi and Blood tonic — meaning it builds foundational energy. It's also used to calm the Shen (spirit/mind), making it uniquely powerful for stress, anxiety, and insomnia rooted in blood deficiency.

## ■ WHAT MODERN SCIENCE SAYS

Jujubes contain extremely high levels of Vitamin C (20x more than apples), polysaccharides with immunomodulatory effects, and saponins with demonstrated sedative properties. Research supports benefits for sleep quality, immune function, and liver protection.

## ■ HOW TO USE IT

- **Simmer 5-8 dates in water for 15-20 min for a daily tonic tea**
- **Add to rice congee or oatmeal for a naturally sweet breakfast**
- **Combine with ginger and goji for the classic trinity tea**
- **Eat 3-5 whole dates as a mid-afternoon snack**

■ **High in natural sugars — moderate intake if managing blood sugar.**

Sources: sevemagique.com · doctonat.com · asie-gourmande.fr

G■u Q■ Z■



# ■■ Goji Berries

Nature: Neutral · Sweet · Organ: Liver · Kidney

## ■ IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE

**Nourishes Liver and Kidney Jing, brightens the eyes, tonifies blood.**

Goji is classified as a tonic for the Liver and Kidney — two organs that govern Jing (vital essence), vision, and reproductive energy. In the classical text Mingyi Bielu (500 AD), goji was described as anti-aging. It's one of the few TCM herbs used both as food and medicine with virtually no side effects.

## ■ WHAT MODERN SCIENCE SAYS

The polysaccharides of Lycium Barbarum (LBP) are among the most studied phytonutrients in TCM. Research confirms antioxidant, immunomodulatory, neuroprotective, and hepatoprotective effects. Rich in zeaxanthin — the specific carotenoid that protects retinal health.

## ■ HOW TO USE IT

- **Eat a small handful (15-20g) daily — raw, as a snack**
- **Add to warm porridge, smoothies, or overnight oats**
- **Brew with chrysanthemum flowers for a classic eye-health tea**
- **Combine with jujube and ginger for the anti-aging trinity**

■ **Avoid if taking blood thinners. Not recommended in large amounts during pregnancy.**

Sources: doctonat.com · laboratoiresbimont.com · PubMed: Lycium Barbarum studies

H■i Zh■ Ma



# ■■■ Black Sesame Seeds

Nature: Neutral · Sweet · Organ: Liver · Kidney

## ■ IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE

**Tonifies Kidney Jing, nourishes blood, strengthens hair, bones and marrow.**

Black sesame is one of the most direct Jing-tonifying foods in the entire TCM system. The kidney governs hair, bones, teeth, hearing, and reproduction — all of which benefit from regular black sesame consumption. It's particularly valued for premature greying, hair loss, and age-related weakness.

## ■ WHAT MODERN SCIENCE SAYS

Black sesame contains sesamol and sesamin — potent antioxidants with anti-inflammatory properties. Rich in calcium, magnesium, zinc, and iron. Contains lignans that support hormonal balance. Studies suggest benefits for oxidative stress, cholesterol, and bone density.

## ■ HOW TO USE IT

- **Grind into powder and add to smoothies or warm milk**
- **Sprinkle on rice, noodles, or roasted vegetables**
- **Make black sesame paste (tahini) — blend with honey for a daily tonic**
- **Mix into homemade energy balls with dates and oats**

■ **High in calories and fat — a tablespoon or two daily is sufficient.**

Sources: visiontimes.fr · helenwatkins.yoga · Traditional TCM pharmacopoeia

Jiang Huáng



# Turmeric

Nature: Warm · Pungent · Bitter · Organ: Spleen · Stomach · Liver

## IN TRADITIONAL CHINESE MEDICINE

**Moves blood and Qi, reduces stagnation, anti-inflammatory, supports liver.**

In TCM, turmeric (Jiang Huang) is valued primarily as a blood and Qi mover — meaning it helps break up stagnation in the body. Stagnation in TCM manifests as pain, inflammation, mood disorders, and digestive sluggishness. It's used for menstrual irregularities, joint pain, and liver congestion.

## WHAT MODERN SCIENCE SAYS

Curcumin — turmeric's active compound — is one of the most researched natural anti-inflammatory agents. Hundreds of studies confirm its ability to inhibit NF-kB inflammatory pathways. Note: bioavailability dramatically increases when combined with black pepper (piperine).

## HOW TO USE IT

- **Make golden milk: warm plant milk + 1 tsp turmeric + black pepper + ginger**
- **Add to soups, curries, and rice dishes**
- **Blend into smoothies with ginger and black pepper**
- **Always combine with black pepper — increases absorption by up to 2,000%**

**Avoid high doses if on blood thinners or before surgery.**

Sources: medecinechinoiseoccitanie.fr · PubMed: Curcumin meta-analyses

BONUS RECIPE

# The Shanghai Morning Tonic

All 5 ingredients · 10 minutes · drink before anything else

## INGREDIENTS

- 3-4 slices fresh ginger
- 4-5 jujube dates, pitted
- 1 tbsp goji berries
- 1 tsp black sesame seeds
- ¼ tsp turmeric + pinch of black pepper

500ml water · optional: raw honey to taste

## METHOD

01 Bring water to a boil in a small saucepan.

02 Add ginger slices and jujube dates. Reduce to simmer.

03 After 10 minutes, add goji berries, sesame and turmeric.

04 Simmer 3 more minutes. Strain into a mug.

05 Add honey if desired. Drink warm — never cold.

## WHY IT WORKS

- Warms the digestive fire before your first meal
- Builds Qi and nourishes blood simultaneously
- Protects Kidney Jing — your vital essence
- Anti-inflammatory from the very first sip
- Supports liver detoxification and Qi circulation

We drink this every morning in Shanghai. It takes 10 minutes and changes the entire trajectory of the day.

# This is just the beginning.

You now have 5 ingredients that have been trusted for 2,500 years.
Here's what to do next.

**This week**
Pick ONE ingredient and add it to your daily routine. Just one. Consistency beats complexity every time.

**Follow @nourishbytwo**
We post new TCM education, recipes, and wellness content every week — all sourced and verified.

**Try the morning tonic**
Make the Shanghai Morning Tonic 3 days in a row. Notice how you feel. Your body will tell you everything.

**Coming soon**
The Ancient Body Reset — a complete 4-week program combining TCM nutrition, fitness, and lifestyle. Join the waitlist via our bio.

**Made with curiosity, from Shanghai to your kitchen. ■**

@nourishbytwo · TCM × Nutrition × Fitness × Lifestyle